



VertiGO!!!



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Section Night 1 December 2008

December club meeting: Unclimbed Peaks of NZ by Kester Brown

Kester is “gonna talk about how much fun it is to do first ascents and give some ideas for places to go and do them in NZ”

Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



Three skiers, two glaciers, one September

Bang! The engine roared and the nose descended. Again, Bang! And simultaneously, “Shriek!” from Sonia. In the back, Trev and I gripped our seats, white knuckled. Fortunately the pilot had warned us about the need to establish a “horizon” on the blank glacier snow, but we weren’t prepared for the violence of that first fly past, lulled during the 20 min flight from Mt Cook village by the magnificence of the scenery. The Cessna rose and quickly banked in to the final approach. Concerns for our own safety quickly turned to that of another ski touring party crossing directly in the line of our rapid approach at the base of the landing site - further convenient “contrast”. As we passed directly overhead we could clearly see the whites of their eyes..

The actual landing was smooth, and we quickly disembarked, unloaded the gear, and with a short roar and snow flurry the plane was gone. Only then did we really begin to appreciate the ski touring heaven we’d been dropped in to. We (Sonia Waters, Blair Leslie (both NZAC Wellington section), and Trev Breen (Otago section)) had arrived at Tasman Saddle in the Mt Cook National Park for five days of ski touring in the second week of September. Fresh snow, inches deep, squealed like dry sand beneath our boots. We stood on a wide gently rolling plateau, with the Tasman glacier descending in roughly two converging snow fields, encompassing Tasman Saddle hut about half a kilometre distant to the South, sitting prominently on a knife edge ridge at 2300 metres. Hochstetter Dome and the Aylmer ridge rose to 2800m to the North; the Main divide from Mt Elie de Beaumont to Mt Cook and beyond ran from the Nor’ to Sou’ West; the huge buttresses of the Malte Brun range towered directly to the South; and to the West, Kelman hut sat like a coin in the knuckle of Mt Abel, above the Tasman Saddle itself, with the Liebig and Two Thumb ranges stretching to the horizon beyond. With clear skies, wicked snow, magnificent terrain and breathtaking scenery – it was ski mountaineer’s catnip.

We quickly gathered our “light” 18 kg packs and skied across the gentle slope to the door of Tasman Saddle hut - our home for the next three nights. We were greeted by our erstwhile “contrast” fellow skiers, a party of 8 out on a day trip from Kelman hut. We exchanged the story of our landing with equally humorous and exhilarating, but clearly different points of view, before heading out to spend the rest of the afternoon skinning back past the landing zone for a magic ski descent from the lower reaches of the Aylmer-Hochstetter south face.

The next day, attempting to justify our slow start by the thought that we wouldn’t want to succumb to any non-existent spring ice, we left the hut at a “responsible” time - 10 am to be precise. The party of 8 from the previous day had carved a skinning track up to the western shoulder of our objective, the Hochstetter Dome. Their tracks provided some peace of mind, as although the avalanche danger in the Mt Cook region had reduced to ‘moderate’ over the previous few days, slopes lee to the Nor’ West were reported to have some potential remaining instability. However, other dangers lurked. A massive serac had crumbled off the ice fall immediately beneath the Dome the previous day, carving a prominent fan across the schrund.

But such concerns were soon behind us, with the dry powder providing perfect skinning conditions, and we were soon on the shoulder, with Mt Elie de Beaumont seeming close enough to touch across the Ledenfeld saddle. We were bathed in sunshine, while West Coast clag filled everything to the Nor’ West. Turning East to the Summit ridge an ice layer 10 cm down slowed progress on the steeper crux, with some loss of grip making skinning hard work. But we soon gained the summit. With lunch on top we enjoyed more magnificent views, this time straight down the Tasman to its confluence with the Rudolph glacier.



Ascending the Hochstetter Dome, with Tasman glacier and Mt Cook (right) beyond

The ski down brought huge smiles and whoops from us all, with 15-20cm of virgin powder and nothing even remotely close to catching our telemark edges. With a few hours of daylight still ahead we made for Kelman – the so called “cold hut” across the nève. The other ski party saw us coming, and brews and more stories were welcome. From Kelman we got our first view of the impressive and somewhat infamous Murchison headwall dropping steeply below, before a gentle ski and skin back to what we had rapidly come to regard as “our” hut. That evening, with the rays of the setting sun filtering in to the old pioneering hut, even the freeze dried meals tasted particularly good.

Sonia and Trev havin a well earned brew, Tasman Saddle hut

The next day we planned to check out the Mannering glacier, so it was back to the Saddle for a closer inspection. With the Murchison Headwall, being lee to the Nor’ West and well known for avalanche activity, we set about digging a monster snow pit – sizeable enough for any self respecting Wellingtonian to park a car in. After half an hour of digging, snow profiling, shear

shovelling and Rutschblocking¹ the verdict on the slope was in – it was a bomber. However, the skiing, on a gluey crust, was not pretty and we were glad to make the bottom, with no points for style. From there it was an easy ski/skate and skin across to the appropriately named Starvation Saddle for lunch.

Some fresh slab releases were an unwelcome sight on the Mannering's true right, and a further snow pit revealed a corresponding hard layer at 30 cm, on a base of poorly consolidated snow. So unfortunately, no skiing the Mannering today.

We were rapidly coming to realise how quickly the snow conditions could change, often dramatically, over a relatively short distance in the area. The day's weather conditions provided a hint of an explanation. Thick West Coast cloud with some wind blown precipitation streamed in a dark curtain from Aylmer across the Murchison glacier, obscuring the Northern edge of the nève, but leaving everything to the South, including Starvation Saddle, only a few hundred meters away, bathed in sun.



Skinning back to the Murchison Headwall. Note West Coast clag to the North

We returned via the Headwall and strolled up Aylmer in increasing clag, with thick quiet snow falling in dappled bright sunlight at the summit. The run back down was the run of the trip, with 400m of vertical descent in perfect snow.

We spent the morning of day four practising some crevasse travel and extraction at the hut, before saying goodbye to Tasman Saddle, and setting off for our next objective: De la Beche hut. We skinned East to the nève below Kelman, before turning West to ski through the towering seracs and heavily crevassed area below the Buttresses. The Tasman glacier's gradient eases as it descends, and the lowering altitude and hot day meant for sticky conditions underfoot and slow progress, but at least plenty of time to take in the scenery.

The 200 meter climb up the moraine wall below De la Beche was perhaps the most unpleasant part of the trip, with a metre or so of snow overlying rotten scree, and the surface firmish for the first 20cm or so, before boots sank thigh deep in the poorly bonded granular snow beneath. We were very pleased to reach the hut for a brew and recuperation, before an evening skin up the lower slopes of the Minarets above the hut. The descent on beautiful spring corn more than made up for the effort of getting there.

Our final day consisted of what seems to be a Mt Cook National park rite of passage – the walk out across the interminable moraine and up the crumbling moraine wall at Garbage Gully. We reached the car at the Ball Hut Road end under torchlight after 12 hours at 8.30 pm, with a feeling well known to skiers in general, but to we three especially – tired but happy.

¹ A "Rutschblock" is a form of snow pack analysis, with the block cut sufficiently wide for a skier to test. I understand that NZ backcountry ski guides do not commonly use it, but we thought we'd give it a go anyway.

We'd originally planned to do the "Symphony on Skis", first described by Gottlieb Braun-Elwert in the 1986 NZ Alpine Club Journal. But with injury and fitness concerns we decided for our much foreshortened version. The "Symphony" involves almost 50km of touring from the Godley Valley to Fox glacier via the Murchison, Tasman, Rudolph and Franz Josef glaciers, and over 4.5 km of ascent, which Gottlieb and 2 companions completed in September 1983 in 18 hours! We bought a copy of the 1986 Journal at the second hand bookshop in Omarama on the way home. Masterfully written, the article starts:

"A ski traverse is like a well composed piece of music. It flows with harmony, surprises with the unexpected. It engages all your emotions and the melody lingers in your mind afterwards. Good music needs players who are the masters of their instruments".

I'm not sure if the last sentence fully applies to we three newcomers, but with even our relatively small bit-part of a journey, we were well satisfied that we'd heard the good music.

Blair Leslie



Rock Activities at Titahi Bay

Desperate to get outdoors after a winter spent climbing at Fergs, a group of Wellington NZAC members including ShiChang "Jeans" Hou, Reece Geurson, Euan Dykes, Gwen Rashbrooke, Manoel Matos, Kevin Patterson, Rob Duerr and Steve "SBD" Minchin have been making regular trips to explore the choss of Titahi Bay. The group are mostly quite new to the sport and so have left the more difficult routes to their own devices, but have made short work of anything that looked remotely friendly. This of course excludes any routes on rock the consistency of rice crackers - a problem which has proved to be all too common and has led to several rock falls which have allowed exciting opportunities to test belayer evacuation speeds and helmet specs. The group has also been increasing the grades of several routes by removing key holds, though this is perhaps balanced by the fact that a number of routes are now significantly shorter due to the quantity of new rock deposited at their base.

Recent trips have focussed on the Lava Torre wall and environs, which has proven to be one of the more interesting parts of the area with opportunities for sport climbs covering a range of grades, some highly entertaining tope roping, and trad climbing with gear so dodgy that it has prompted more than one retreat from routes my granny could have climbed. If nothing else these experiences mean that climbing on anything other than greywacke will be a breeze...

Kevin has posted some photos from these trips on his facebook page:

<http://www.facebook.com/album.php?aid=62915&l=d5ab5&id=783826158>

Steve Minchin



CLASSIFIED



New Guidebook Release - Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed

The long anticipated guidebook to rock, ice and mixed climbing in Queenstown is finally out. After more than two years of intense dedication to this project, editor Guillaume Charton has compiled a thorough guidebook.

This book features hundreds of new climbs, new crags as well as ice and mixed climbing around Queenstown. Many local climbers have assisted, including: Aaron and Sally Ford, Mike Dunn, Tony Burnell, Dave Bolger and Rupert Gardiner.



Mountaineering from the Milford Road

I recently bought a few copies of Gerry Hall-Jones's latest book, an illustrated history of early climbing in the Darrans, so please contact me if you would like to buy one (they are \$44, you can also order direct from Gerry at 72 Park St Invercargill). Gerry Hall-Jones has climbed and written prolifically on the Darran mountains of Fiordland, including being on the first ascent of the south-east ridge of Tutoko (ever since, it has been the route to do on the mountain) and three editions of Moir's guidebook. His latest book covers the years from 1895 to about 1970: 120 pages, hard cover, colour and B&W illustrations, including many never published before.

Richard Thomson

Ph 383 4224

Email richard@growingwild.co.nz



CLUB NOTICES



Help Needed - Organiser for BANNF 2009

From Committee We are looking for a volunteer to put their hand up for us to organise the BANNF 2009 film festival in Wellington.

This is the club's premier event on the annual calendar and we are again looking to run a successful local event in Wellington in May 2009.

The job entails:

- liaison between The Paramount Theatre and NZAC Headquarters who are managing the event
- film selection and programming
- managing promotion on the ground locally throughout Wellington
- sales of complimentary tickets

If you're interested in taking this on please contact James Wright on 027 4725561 or **email**.



OUMC Centenary

"The Oxford University Mountaineering Club are pleased to celebrate their Centenary in 2009. The focus of their celebrations will be a reunion dinner in Wolfson College, Oxford on March 14th 2009. Any old members of the club are invited to attend. Further details can be found at www.oumcball.org.uk <<http://www.oumcball.org.uk/>> , or from oumcball@gmail.com or OUMC Centenary Committee, c/o 27 Spencer Crescent, Oxford, OX4 4SN, UK"



The ANU Expedition to Mt Sabre 2009

The Mountaineering Club of the Australian National University in Canberra has awarded an Expedition fund grant to four of its members to travel to the Darren Mountains in New Zealand to gain experience on some big rock climbs. The target is the NE Buttress of Mt Sabre, a classic route of twenty odd pitches up to grade 17. Charles Jenkins, a senior fellow in the Astronomy dept with the assistance of his wife Fiona and Guy Coulson of the NZAC Auckland section will lead the trip. The aim of the trip is to bring three young (undergraduate or postgraduate) student members of the club on a training expedition to give them a taste of climbing on big hills in remote areas – with the hope that they'll then go on to bigger and better things in the greater ranges.

Charles, Fiona and Guy along with Guy's wife, Esther, have been climbing together for the best part of two decades beginning in Cambridge in the late 1980s. They soon discovered a shared affinity for steep limestone, preferably sea cliffs and preferably remote. The following decade and a half involved them dragging their families around the UK in search of this esoteric experience. After fifteen years climbing together in the UK, both families ended up in the Southern Hemisphere about three or four years ago. The climbing partnership continued with two unsuccessful attempts on Mt Aspiring, both times beaten by the weather, and now attempts the Darrans.

Guy's experience also includes extensive Scottish winter, Alpine summer and polar, whilst Charles and Fiona have also climbed in the Northern Alps, Scotland and Southern Africa.

The other three members of the team are Sam Margerison, Jack Chenoweth and Andrew Peters. Sam has been a keen outdoors man since school and has been a member of the ANU Mountaineering Club for the last ten years. He likes pretty much all outdoor activities, especially bushwalking, cross country skiing, canyoning, rock climbing and mountaineering. In 2007, Sam was part of a group of ANUMCers who did a mountaineering course with Aspiring Guides, followed by an almost-successful attempt on Mt Sealy. He has climbed at Booroomba, Nowra and Arapiles, and is eager to try a major rock route at moderate grades

Jack is currently the President of the ANU Mountaineering Club and has been interested and active in the outdoors since being hauled along, cold, tired and grumpy on cross country ski trips as a 10 year old by his father. He tries to go back-country skiing as often as time and unpredictable Australian snow conditions allow and also rockclimbs when (as is often the case) there is no snow. This winter he went climbing for the first time in the Southern Alps. Intending to spend 3 weeks climbing around Pioneer Hut he instead spent 8 days at the Fox Glacier pub and 8 days inside Pioneer Hut drinking tea. He is currently studying music and is a violinist.

Andrew started climbing on rock in 2004 and started leading trad in 2007. He has done most of his outdoor rockclimbing at Booroomba and Arapiles. He started alpine climbing in 2007 and has already spent two month long periods in NZ. In Jan-Feb 2007 he attended an instruction course at Centennial Hut followed a week up the West Matukituki and a week around Mt Cook Village. In June-July 2008 he spent three weeks in Pioneer Hut.

The trip will take place in late February to early March 2009 with the idea of walking in to the Phil's Bivy area from the Gunn Hut, setting up camp and then seeing what develops, mostly with the weather of course. We would welcome any advice on climbing in the area, particularly on logistics and transport into and out of the Hollyford Valley, and any details on where exactly the route up the Sabre goes (avoiding the wally stopper ²pitch if possible). Contact Guy Coulson on guyesther@maxnet.co.nz or drop into Galbraith's on a Wednesday evening...



Discussion Groups

² Joe Brown's description of the hard move that appears a few meters up Cenotaph Corner. I don't know if "wally" translates south of the equator.

Two email discussion groups have been set up for use by Wellington Section members of the Alpine Club. They are intended to be used to communicate articles of interest, useful information, coordination of trips, or raise issues for debate. Please use this resource considerably. Due to recent changes in our IT you will need to re-subscribe to these.

General Discussion Group

To subscribe to the group send an email to:

discussion-subscribe@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

You can unsubscribe at any time by sending an email to:

discussion-unsubscribe@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Once you have subscribed you can email messages to the group at:

discussion@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Rock Climbing Discussion Group

To subscribe to the group send an email to:

wellingtonrock-subscribe@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

You can unsubscribe at any time by sending an email to:

wellingtonrock-unsubscribe@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Once you have subscribed you can email messages to the group at:

wellingtonrock@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



ROCK CLIMBING



2009 National Bouldering Series - Baring Head Rock Hop

- Registration from 9.00am
- Competitors briefing at 9.45am
- Competition starts at 10.00am sharp!

If its raining on Saturday the competition will be held on Sunday. Weather postponement details will be updated **here** by 9am on the day.

Categories will be Expert, Junior and Recreational with male and female divisions in each.

Further information at **www.nbs.org.nz**



Summer Rock

We are now taking registrations for Summer Rock 2009.

Summer Rock is an ideal introduction to rock climbing with no previous climbing experience necessary.

It aims to give people the skills to safely and efficiently lead on single pitch bolted routes, and belay and second on multi-pitch naturally protected routes.

The course will run over the following times at venues throughout Wellington and the central North Island:

- Weekend 31st January - Instructors Training Weekend
- Tuesday 3rd February - Fergs
- Tuesday 10th February - Fergs
- Weekend 14th February - Baring Head & Fergs
- Tuesday 17th February - Fergs
- Tuesday 24th February - Fergs
- Weekend 28th February - Titahi Bay & Fergs
- Tuesday 3rd March - Fergs
- Tuesday 10th March - Fergs
- Weekend 14th March - Wharepapa South
- Tuesday 17th March - Fergs
- Tuesday 24th March - Fergs
- Weekend 28th March - Whanganui Bay

If you wish to register please email **Blair Hiscoke** or call Blair on (027) 233 2468 (after 5pm).



CLUB TRIPS



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

5-7Dec08 – Whanganui Bay – Trip Leader Steve Minchin – Level = Grade 16-25+ Rock

Come join us for a weekend of sport (and some trad) climbing at Whanganui Bay. Plan is to leave Wellington after work on Friday evening and tent for 2 nights at the Bay. With over 1000 routes to choose on classic ignimbrite rock adjacent to the beautiful Lake Taupo from this is truly the Mecca of North Island rock climbing. Contact Steve at 021 127 3925 or by email at stevem@solutionz.co.nz



27Dec07 – 3Jan08 – National NZAC Climbing Camp – Matakitaki Valley (Nelson Lakes NP)

A great opportunity to meet fellow climbers from other club sections, and to team up to tackle some of the local peaks including the challenging Mt Ella (2253m). See <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=377> for details. Car pooling from Wellington is being coordinated through Kevin. Contact me at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



5-8Feb09 – Waitangi Weekend – Whakapapa Gorge (Tongariro NP) – Level = 10-27 (Rock) – Trip Leader TBA

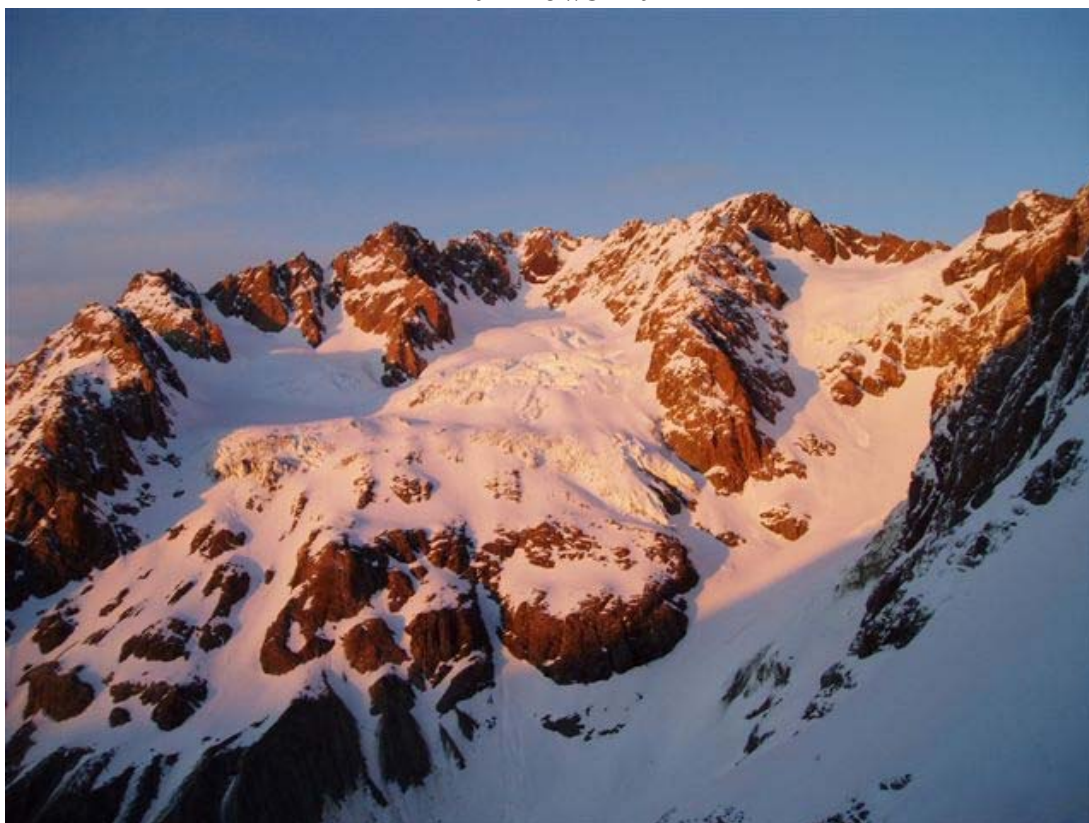
Come trad climbing over the long weekend on Ruapehu. Some 30+ routes available. Only 5 minutes walk from the Whakapapa Carpark. We'll either be staying at one of the ski lodges or down at Whakapapa Village Campground.



8-14Aug09 – Easter Weekend – Arrowsmiths from the Lawrence - = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience - Trip Leader TBA

Chance to use some of those lazy last days of the autumn before the first of the snows come in. Walk in will be from Erewhon. The rock is better on western side of the Arrowsmith range. Friday High Camp, Saturday Summit, Sunday Spare Day, Monday Walk Out, Tuesday drive home. There exists the potential for doing a new rock route so bring your cams!

Mt Arrowsmith





AUCKLAND . WELLINGTON

Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail
- Rental

Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.

Study Sport @ University of Otago, Dunedin.

Distance Learning Programme

The University of Otago has sports study opportunities available by Distance Learning during Semester one 2009.

Study towards a Diploma in Sports Studies or a Certificate in Fitness Management

Prior University experience not required.

For further information contact:

Beverley Lawrence

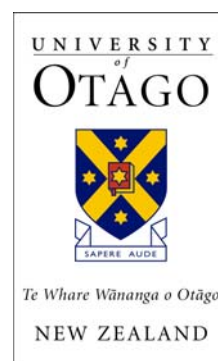
Sports Studies Administrator

Phone +64 3 479 7683

E-mail: beverley.lawrence@otago.ac.nz

Website:

<http://physed.otago.ac.nz/courses/distance/index.html>





Federated Mountain Clubs of NZ (Inc)

P O Box 1604
WELLINGTON

FMC Member News November 2008

New Government and Outdoor Recreation

The newly elected National Government has indicated that it will have new policies on the management of conservation lands, RMA management and outdoor recreation. The significance placed on Tourism by incoming Prime Minister, John Key, will also have impact on recreational land management. FMC will be monitoring the new government policies carefully. If FMC member clubs, or individual members, have issues that should be raised with the new government, they should email details to Phil Glasson; secretary@fmc.org.nz

National Outdoor Recreation Policy Development

In pre-election campaigning, Helen Clark announced the formation of the Sir Edmund Hillary Outdoor Recreation Council. It will come under SPARC's control. A committee has been appointed to make policy recommendations to SPARC regarding the membership of the council and its procedures by February 2009. The Committee members are:

Rob Fisher (Chair) - SPARC Board Member; Chairman, Simpson Grierson.

Dr. Mike Boyes - Board Member, Outdoors New Zealand; Senior Lecturer in outdoor education, Otago University School of Physical Education.

Kerry Marshall - Mayor of Nelson; former Chairman, New Zealand Conservation Authority; former Director, Roads and Parks.

Dr. Kay Booth - Board Member, New Zealand Walking Access Commission, & New Zealand Conservation Authority.

The government's Outdoor Recreation Strategy will also be released in February.

Security Concession on Conservation Land Opposed

FMC is investigating the application for a concession by Provision Security to operate on Department of Conservation land, adjacent to the Stockton coal mine (operated by Solid Energy), to "undertake security operations including investigations, filming and patrolling, for the purpose of ensuring public safety and enforcement of any closure under the Conservation Act." This application was not publicly notified. FMC believes that this should have occurred, given the concession's unusual nature and the possible precedent that its granting could have on free public access to lands managed by DoC. FMC has been assured that the public have access to public conservation land unless it is subject to a closure governed by conditions of the Conservation Act 1987 (Stewardship & Ecological Areas). Following registration of member concern, FMC is formally registering opposition to granting of the concession. The Department is still considering the application and no decision has been made on whether it will be granted or declined. Further feedback from FMC members is welcome.

St James Station Recreational Planning

FMC Executive member, Tony Haddon, and Bulletin Editor, Shaun Barnett, will join other recreational stakeholders for a two day planning meeting in early December 2008 to discuss various options for the St James Station. The former high country station in the headwaters of the Waiau River is also the location of the St James Walkway. It offers excellent tramping and climbing opportunities, including transalpine trips into the Lewis Pass National Reserve, Nelson Lakes National Park and the Molesworth Station Recreational Area. FMC clubs with ideas to contribute to the plan should contact Tony Haddon through: secretary@fmc.org.nz

Molesworth Recreation Plan Reminder

FMC encourages members and clubs to explore the recreational opportunities on Molesworth Station this summer (e.g. tramping, climbing, camping, mountain biking, kayaking, hunting and fishing). A new management plan will be developed in 2009. We are keen to ensure that your ideas are represented in the recreational section of the plan. Please let us have your views on new opportunities that you would like to have covered by the plan and any access problems that need to be sorted. Send your ideas and comments to secretary@fmc.org.nz

Welcome Flat Hot Pools

DoC is considering using hot water from the Welcome Flat hot pools for heating the nearby hut. While FMC supports the need for the Department to consider energy and cost savings, it also recognises that the pools provide one of the quintessential New Zealand backcountry experiences, savoured by a diverse range of outdoor users. FMC has urged the Department to consult the public before any decisions are made and that any proposal to harness the geothermal energy is accompanied by unequivocal scientific or engineering evidence that the pools will not be affected.

Great Walk Season – Tongariro Northern Circuit

FMC recently asked DoC why the off-season for the Tongariro Northern Circuit was shorter than for all other Great Walks (after Queen's Birthday to before Labour weekend, as opposed to 1 May-30 September for all the others). We pointed out that the 'shoulder' season on Great Walks – the period between the end of the official season and the arrival of alpine conditions – is valued by clubs. DoC's response was that the later arrival of alpine conditions on Tongariro and the resultant higher numbers on the track early in winter justified the current approach. FMC is interested in whether your club accepts DoC's reasoning or whether we should take the matter further. Send your ideas and comments to secretary@fmc.org.nz

Waikato Conservation Management Strategy (CMS)

The Department of Conservation's Waikato Conservancy has recently issued a draft of its new CMS, for public consultation. The FMC has circulated all clubs with a CD copy of the proposed strategy. Submissions close on Friday 9 January 2009. The CMS provides not only the conservation strategy, but also the recreation facilities strategy for many places that clubs take trips to. It provides the basis for the management of forest parks and conservation areas for the next 10 years at least. FMC will make a written submission to the Conservancy on behalf of all of the clubs and will represent them at the subsequent hearing before the Waikato Conservation Board. To make the FMC submission truly representative it is essential that the clubs and their members with local knowledge provide FMC with their views; both criticisms and positive wishes for recreation in the places that the CMS covers. Please send your club's comments to the FMC representative for your club, or to Viv Milne; milne@ps.gen.nz

New FMC Representative for Land SAR

Richard Davies, a member of the FMC Executive, has been confirmed as our representative on the Land SAR Board. Richard succeeds Laurie Gallagher who gave sterling service being our representative for many years. Land SAR is the national organisation of Search & Rescue volunteers, who are members of either individual Land SAR groups, professional groups such as the police, or volunteer members of tramping and climbing clubs. Since it helped establish SAR in the 1930s FMC has taken an active interest in Land SAR management with particular reference to volunteer members. If your club has any ideas that will contribute to the continuing improvement of Land SAR services, please contact Richard through: secretary@fmc.org.nz

Change to 2009 AGM Date

The date has changed to Saturday 20 June 2009 and not on 6 June as previously notified. The venue remains the same (Brentwood Hotel near the airport). Clubs from out of Wellington are advised to make any accommodation bookings they require as soon as possible. (Ph 04 920 0400, or e-mail reservations@brentwoodhotel.co.nz)



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2008/9 CONTACT LIST

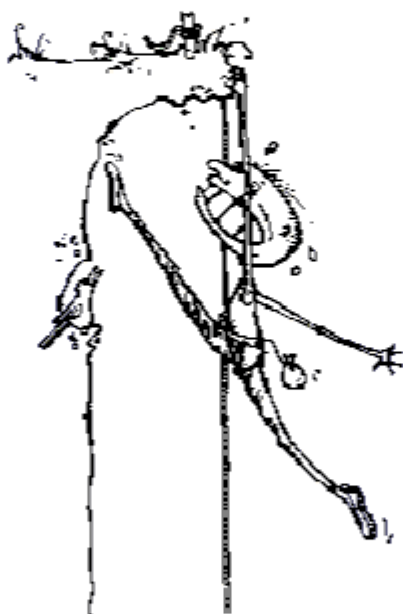
	NAME	EMAIL ALIAS *	PHONE
Chairperson	vacant	CHAIRPERSON	
<i>Vice Chairperson</i>	Gwen Rashbrooke	VICECHAIR or GR	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	SECRETARY or CM2	(04) 973 1307 (h)
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER or KD	N/A
<i>National Representative</i>	James Wright	JW	(04) 2327748 (h) (027) 4725561
Committee Members	Andrea Logan	AL	N/A
	Kate Davidson	KD2	N/A
	Kevin Patterson	KP	N/A
	Scott Taylor	ST	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	Shichang Hou	SH	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
Instruction – Summer Rock	Blair Hiscoke	SUMMERROCK or BH	N/A
Instruction - Alpine	Don French	AIC or DF	(06) 3777117 (h)
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS or KP	934 0975 (h) (027) 687 9573
Newsletter Editor	Jo Langridge	NEWSLETTER or JL	N/A
Website Editor	James Wright	JW	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	DRILL or KF	N/A
Club Gear	Vacant	GEAR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A

* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund or general queries should be directed to the Secretary

Any media queries should be directed to:

National Executive Officer: Ollie Clifton ollie@alpineclub.org.nz (03) 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

